

your non-bootable Windows 2000 CD and then type `'drive: \i386\winnt.exe'` at the prompt. This starts off the installation in MS-DOS mode.

Retrieving Linux partition

Q I have a PIII 933 MHz system with 128 MB RAM and a 20 GB hard disk. I have two Windows partitions and one Linux partition. I run Windows XP and Mandrake 8.1, and the dual boot system worked fine. However, the boot option disappeared when I installed Windows 98 on the Windows partition, and the Linux partition is inaccessible. How can I boot into Linux and retrieve my Linux partition?

Arindam Sarkar

A The Windows 98 installation flushed the Master Boot Record, and hence you lost the boot loader (LILO or GRUB) that was installed by Mandrake 8.1. There are a number of ways to restore the boot loader.

One of them is to use a utility called LOADLIN that is present in the Linux CD under the DOS utilities folder. Copy this utility into a folder called, say, LOADLIN in the C drive. Next, boot to Windows 98 in MS-DOS mode and type `'C:\LOADLIN> LOADLIN vmlinuz /dev/hdb1 ro'` at the command prompt. Here `'vmlinuz'` is the Linux kernel image that's located in the DOS utilities folder of the Linux CD and `'/dev/hdb1'` is the location of your Linux partition. The kernel should be available in the same directory as that of LOADLIN. This loads the Linux operating system, and then type `'LILO'` when you get to the Linux command prompt.

If this does not fix it, do a minimal install of Mandrake 8.1 using the installation CD. Here, choose to upgrade when you get the install options, but don't select any files for upgrading. This way, the setup installs the boot loader and the whole installation finishes in about 10 minutes.

CPU cooler for AMD

Q I own a Compaq Presario S3010IL PC that has an AMD XP 2000+ processor. SiSandra2003 reports that my CPU fan is spinning at 981 rpm only, and the system fan speed is 1,850 rpm. I verified this with the BIOS information, and found them to be the same and that's the reason why the system becomes hot after a few minutes of operation. I would like to know the recommended fan speed for the AMD Athlon XP 2000+.

Devasish

AMD overclocking.

Q I just upgraded my PC to an AMD AthlonXP 2000+, Asus Nforce motherboard and a 40 GB hard disk. I heard that the Athlon XP2000+ can be safely over-clocked up to 2 GHz.

How do I do that?

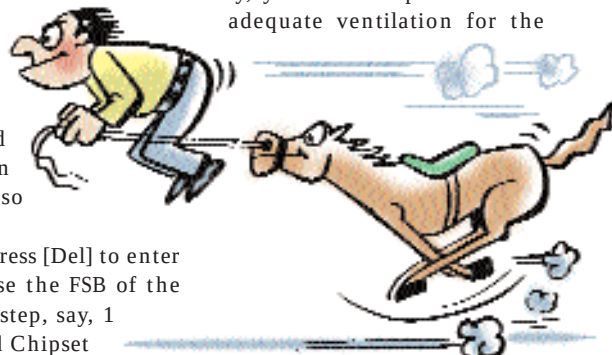
Girish Kulkarni

A AMD processors can be overclocked easily, but do bear in mind that doing so reduces their life.

Start the system, press [Del] to enter the BIOS and increase the FSB of the processor by a small step, say, 1 MHz in the Advanced Chipset features. At the same time, also increase the memory speed in the same way. Keep doing this until you have a stable system. Frequent crashes after tweaking the system indicate that it has been overclocked above limits. You will have to decrease the above-mentioned FSB speed.

You also need to have some of the

following accessories to ensure that you don't blow up the processor. The first and foremost is a quality heat sink and fan combination—ideally, a copper heat sink with a high-rpm fan on it. Secondly, you need a spacious cabinet with adequate ventilation for the



circulating air to bring down the temperature within the cabinet.

As said earlier, overclocking tends to reduce the life span of all the components and it also makes your warranty void. Indeed it's risky; so don't do anything unless you know what it is you intend doing.

A SiSoft Sandra does not measure the fan speed; it just takes the data available from the BIOS and displays it. Also, the BIOS is often incorrect in measuring the actual fan speed, temperature, etc. Hence, you cannot take its word for the spinning speed.

Open the chassis and check the speed of the fan. As a thumb rule, if you can make out or read the name written on the fan, then, yes, it's slow. However, if it's blurred out and the green AMD logo looks white, then the fan is running at the right speed. It is just the BIOS that is reporting the wrong speed, for which you can ask Compaq support to provide you with an updated BIOS. The recommended fan speed for the Athlon XP is approximately 5000 rpm and it is always good to go for a faster one, say the Volcano series from Thermaltake.

Can't delete from floppy

Q While formatting a floppy, I received a message that it was already formatted. However, it would not let me store a 500 KB file on it saying that the drive was full and I needed to insert another floppy. I did so and the error appeared yet again. So, I tried deleting the files, but even that did not happen. I bought a

new floppy drive and installed a new cable, but it was of no use. However, the disk worked fine on my friend's computer. I think the motherboard has some defect and needs to be replaced. Also, are there any IDE cables that work with floppy drives?

Akash Chhibber

A Akash, had there been a problem with your motherboard, the floppy drive would not have turned up in Windows Explorer. Since you can see it there, nothing is wrong with the board. Check the 'Standard Setup' in the BIOS settings to see if the floppy disk type is set to '1.44 MB'. Also, the 'Floppy Disk Controller' in the 'Integrated Peripherals' menu should be set to 'Enabled'. In 'Advanced BIOS Setup', set 'Boot up floppy seek' to 'Enabled'. This forces the BIOS to check for a working drive every time it boots.

Try deleting the contents of the floppy, by getting into DOS mode and typing `'a: DEL *.*'` at the prompt, or format it in the DOS mode using `'format a:'`.

Floppy drives use their own connectors and cables. They do not use an IDE interface and consequently, do not work with an IDE cable.